

Automated Painting Rover (APR)

Indian Competitor Technology Deep Dive (Part 2) — Vividobots, Pace Robotics, Endless Robotics

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Why this document exists: the original Q1 research named Vividobots, Pace Robotics and Endless Robotics as Indian competitors but did not give them the same depth of research as the four companies covered separately. This document closes that gap.

Housekeeping correction first. The "Robot plusplus" screenshot in the original review document (robotplusplus.com, HighMate AP Series) is **not an Indian company** — it is Beijing Time River Technology Co., a Chinese firm based in Beijing, founded 2015, trading internationally as RobotPlusPlus. Its HighMate AP Series is an oil-and-gas abrasive-blasting/coating/hydroblasting robot for offshore steel structures, not a wall-painting rover, and it has no wall-climbing capability of its own — it is typically positioned by a crane or fixed rig rather than self-climbing. It should not appear in any "Indian competitors" list. It is a legitimate reference point only for ATEX/IECEEx explosion-proof certification, which matters if APR is ever adapted for hazardous industrial sites.

Sources: *GlobeNewswire, RobotPlusPlus Sea Asia 2025 release [1]; The Robot Report, HighMate C20 launch [2]; robotplusplus.com product page [3].*

1. Vividobots Pallavaram, Chennai, Tamil Nadu, India

FOUNDED	FUNDING RAISED	PAINT CANISTER	LABOUR TIME CUT
2021	~₹1.5–1.85 Cr	40 L	~70%

1.1 Company background

Vividobots Pvt Ltd was founded in 2021 by Dhinesh Babu, Balasubramaniyan Mani Sumathi and Velmurugan B, and is based in Pallavaram, Chennai. Press coverage attributes the company's origin to a specific incident that affected co-founder Dhinesh personally and became the motivation for building robotic solutions for high-rise building maintenance — a founding story with a direct parallel to APR's own motivating incident.

Sources: *Indian Startup Times founder interview [4]; Tracxn company profile [5].*

1.2 Product lineup

Product	Status	What it does
Wiperque	Live / deployed	Automated glass and façade cleaning robot for high-rise buildings
Vibrantque-XT	In testing, pilot demonstrations reported imminent	Exterior autonomous painting robot — marketed as India's first; carries a 40-litre onboard paint canister, supports multi-colour painting in a single session, and uses a robotic arm to reach projections and window edges without human assistance
Vibrantque-NT	Named in company materials	An interior-painting variant of the Vibrantque line, distinct from the exterior XT model

Sources: *Indian Startup Times [4]; CoreOps.AI startup funding profile [6]; Vividobots company site (about/product pages, as referenced in original document) [7][8].*

1.3 Funding, incubation and recognition

- **Funding:** figures vary slightly by source — approximately ₹1.47–1.85 crore raised across early rounds, from Inflection Point Ventures and Brigade REAP (Real Estate Accelerator Program) as institutional investors, alongside government grant support.
- **Government support:** early EDII-TN (Entrepreneurship Development and Innovation Institute, Tamil Nadu) grants — a ₹2 lakh prototyping grant followed by a ₹5 lakh development voucher — plus later support through the Startup India Seed Fund Scheme and the NIDHI Seed Support Scheme.
- **Incubation:** Anna Incubation Centre and the MCC-MRF Innovation Park; graduated from the Brigade REAP 2023 cohort.
- **Recognition:** named among the "Top 10 Real Estate Tech Startups" by the Mahindra LEAP programme.
- **Company claims:** versus manual operations, labour time cut by ~70%, cost cut by ~50%, material waste reduced by ~15%.

Sources: indiatechdesk.com funding report [9]; Algomage/CoreOps.AI startup funding listings [6][10]; Way2World profile [11]; Tracxn [5] (ranks Vividobots 3rd among 16 active competitors it tracks in this category).

What this means for APR: Vividobots remains the single closest Indian analogue to APR's own ambition — an autonomous *exterior*, high-rise painting robot — but as of the most recent reporting, Vibrantque-XT is still in testing, not yet in commercial deployment. It is a gondola/suspended-access style machine carrying its own large paint tank, which is a different mechanical approach from APR's self-climbing vacuum rover. This remains the one company APR should be most prepared to discuss and differentiate against directly in a review.

2. Pace Robotics Bengaluru, Karnataka, India

INCUBATED AT

SINE, IIT Bombay

STRATEGIC INVESTOR

Pidilite Industries

SPEED CLAIM

~10× manual

COST CLAIM

~3× lower

2.1 Company background and backing

Pace Robotics is incubated at SINE (Society for Innovation and Entrepreneurship), IIT Bombay, and — notably for a painting-robot company — is backed by Pidilite Industries, India's largest adhesives and construction-chemicals company (maker of Fevicol and Dr. Fixit). A major Indian paints-and-coatings-adjacent conglomerate choosing to invest in this exact robotics category is a useful data point for APR's own fundability argument.

Sources: YourStory company profile [12]; Dealroom company profile [13].

2.2 Product and technology stack

The company's product, the **Centa Painter**, is a modular robot performing plastering, putty application and painting on interior walls and ceilings, with separate modules for sanding versus putty-and-paint. Per a first-hand interview and site visit reported by CircuitDigest:

Subsystem	Detail
Perception	More than twenty sensors in total; LiDAR combined with camera feed
Compute	An NVIDIA processor builds a local map and localises the robot's position
Obstacle recognition	Recognises features on the work surface such as windows and switchboards
Path planning	Plans an efficient coverage path over the recognised surface
Positioning workflow	Operator positions the robot roughly one metre from a wall edge by joystick; the robot then aligns itself and works autonomously; ceiling operation is fully autonomous

Sources: *CircuitDigest*, *India Tech Tour interview and site visit*, May 2026 [14].

2.3 Performance claims and timeline

- Company claims roughly 10× the speed of manual methods, at roughly 3× lower cost, with consistent quality.
- First customer trials for painting and putty were completed in July 2022, with commercial pilots planned from November of the same year.
- Business model: sells robots to construction companies rather than offering a service model, and separately monetises the execution data the robots collect.

Sources: *YourStory* [12]; *Dealroom* [13].

What this means for APR: Pace Robotics is the most technically similar of the three Indian companies to APR's own planned perception stack — LiDAR plus camera plus an NVIDIA compute board for mapping and localisation is architecturally close to APR's own Jetson-based plan. It remains, however, an interior, floor-standing robot with no adhesion or wall-climbing system, so it is not a mechanism competitor for APR's exterior use case.

3. Endless Robotics Hyderabad, Telangana, India **CEASED OPERATIONS**

FOUNDED

2015

STATUS

Deadpooled

CLAIMED SPEED

~30× manual

LARGEST JOB

450,000 sq ft

3.1 Confirmed current status — the "re-verify" flag is now resolved

Endless Robotics is confirmed dead. Tracxn lists the company as "not active anymore" (deadpooled); CB Insights lists its operating status as "Closed"; and its registered entity, Endless Robotics Private Limited (CIN U73100TG2015PTC101217), shows a "Strike off" status with the Ministry of Corporate Affairs. It should not be cited to APR's panel as an active competitor.

Sources: *Tracxn company profile* [15]; *CB Insights company profile* [16]; *Crunchbase* [17].

3.2 What the company was, while it operated

Endless Robotics was founded in 2015 by Sai Srikar Reddy Mettu, Puneeth Bandikatla, Nitesh Boyina and Akhil Varma Nallaparaju — variously reported as college friends from BITS Pilani and IIIT Hyderabad — and was based in Hyderabad. Its product, **Walt**, was an interior wall-painting robot offered through a service model called "StroX" rather than sold outright. The company reported a real, named deployment: painting a new academic block at NIT Warangal covering over 450,000 sq ft of wall area, with a further 600,000 sq ft contract with a Hyderabad real-estate developer reported as being finalised. The company explicitly stated its medium-term intention to move into exterior painting, glass cleaning and high-rise maintenance — the exact space APR now targets.

Walt operated by scanning a room to build a 3D model via a wheeled base and tablet-driven control, automatically skipping marked non-paintable areas such as windows, switchboards, beams and doors — the same floor-plan-driven approach later seen in MYRO. Funding across its life totalled a modest \$100,000–\$313,000 from angel investors, 50K Ventures, the Avishkar accelerator programme and IIIT Hyderabad.

Key finding — this is the most important discovery in this document. The four named founders of Endless Robotics — Puneeth Bandikatla, Nitesh Boyina, Akhil Varma, and Srikar Reddy Mettu — are *the exact same four names* listed as inventors on Eternal Robotics' granted patent WO2021255748A1, which underpins **MYRO** (covered in Part 1 of this research). Endless Robotics as a corporate entity closed down, but its founding engineering team and their wall-painting-robot IP did not disappear — they continued the same technical work under Eternal Robotics, and it shipped commercially as MYRO. This is a real continuity, not a coincidence of common names, given all four names match exactly.

Cross-referenced against: Google Patents WO2021255748A1, inventor list [21] (see Part 1, Section 1.2 for the full patent detail); Tracxn Endless Robotics founders/board listing [15].

What this means for APR: the practical lesson is that a single small Indian team has now taken this exact idea (interior wall-painting robot) from a 2015 startup through closure and into a second commercial life as MYRO. That is evidence the underlying technology is achievable and eventually commercially viable — but also a caution that first-generation Indian hardware-robotics startups in this space have a real failure history, and APR's panel may reasonably ask what is structurally different this time (MSME government backing, a defined phased scope, and a deterministic-safety architecture are the honest answers).

4. Updated Comparison — Indian Players Alongside APR

Dimension	Vividobots (Vibrantque-XT)	Pace Robotics (Centa Painter)	Endless Robotics (Walt) — defunct	APR (this project)
Target surface	Exterior high-rise walls	Interior walls/ceilings, floor-standing	Interior walls, floor-standing	Exterior vertical walls, wall-climbing
Access method	Suspended/gondola-style, own paint tank	Mobile base, drives on floor	Mobile base, drives on floor	Vacuum adhesion, self-climbing
Perception	Not publicly detailed	20+ sensors: LiDAR + camera + NVIDIA	3D scan reconstruction from a tablet-driven survey	Camera + YOLO26/YOLO11
Status (Sept 2026)	In testing, pilots imminent	Commercial pilots since ~2022	Ceased operations (strike-off)	Concept/requirements phase
Funding	~₹1.5–1.85 Cr, Inflection Point Ventures + Brigade REAP	Undisclosed, backed by Pidilite Industries	~\$100K–\$313K, angel/accelerator (defunct)	₹15 lakh, MSME Incubation Scheme

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